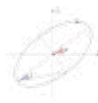




Going mechanical?

Thinking of buying a mechanical keyboard? Here's a great article for those who want to hop on board the bandwagon and know nothing about them <http://digit.in/mechkeyb>



Bitcoin Polarization

Ever wondered how virtual bitcoins can be polarized? Be sure to read this one 'til the end <http://digit.in/polbitc>

Bazaar

Yu Yureka

Yu got it right

So the first Yu Yureka sale is over and Micromax has everything, the controversy, the split second flash sale, but most importantly, a smartphone that is actually very good. It's not often that you would have heard this, but the Yu Yureka is nothing like what Micromax has ever made, which is perhaps why Micromax went for the product differentiation and created a whole new brand for this device.

The Yu Yureka runs on the Snapdragon 615 chipset, which gives it ample power along with 4G support. In addition, CyanogenMod 11 adds a number of features, which you would otherwise not have on your Android smartphone. It gives an impressive AnTuTu score of nearly 32,000, while the graphics performance of just over 9,000 on 3D Mark Unlimited is also more than satisfactory for phone in this price range.

None of that really sets the Yureka apart though, because we've seen it with recent Xiaomi devices. The phone has a good 13MP camera as well, which you may even say is better than the Redmi Note 4G (its only competitor right now), but it's only slightly better in the low light department. What sets the Yureka aside and above the Redmi Note 4G is its looks. While this is in no way the best looking smartphone in the market today, for a sub-₹10k phablet, the Moonstone finish on the back does just fine.

In our tests, there was really very little separating the Yu Yureka from the Xiaomi Redmi Note 4G. Both the devices were satisfactory for the price range, but we still tilt towards the Yureka, not only because of the slightly superior performance, but because of the newer hardware. The Redmi Note is essentially an outdated device when compared to the Yureka, which stands to gain from future OS updates because of its newer hardware.

The new Qualcomm chipset and their 64-bit architecture are built essentially for Lollipop, which means the new version of Google's software



Price
₹8,999



should help the device. In addition, the Yureka also costs ₹1,000 less than the Redmi Note 4G, while still offering 4G connectivity, making it the better choice.

The Yureka's weakness is threefold. First, the 720p resolution doesn't quite suit the 5.5-inch display, making it not sharp enough for us to really like it. While we do understand that the price range justifies this, we still can't call this display good. Secondly, CyanogenMod, like it was on the OnePlus One, isn't the stablest OS you can find for a phone.

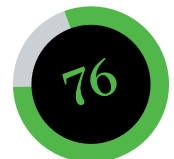
If you know about CM, you would know this yourself and the instability won't be a problem for you if you like tinkering with your phone's software. That said, for a regular user, sudden

app crashes may be an issue, even if they're not very many. CyanogenMod on the Yureka is like a double edged sword, while it does add a ton of new features and offer more control over your phone, it also adds this drawback to it.

Lastly, the 2500 mAh battery on the Yureka is not enough for a phablet. Micromax insisted the Cyanogen's OS optimisation would allow for capacity upto 3200 mAh and while that is true, a one day battery life is not what you would want out of a phablet. We had to work a little hard to get this smartphone to last us the whole day. The battery life is almost similar to the Redmi Note on regular usage, but like we had said in that review, even that wasn't enough.

Overall, we were quite satisfied with the Yu Yureka smartphone. It takes the cake over its competitors and is unlike any smartphone that Micromax has had to offer till date. In fact, it's unlike any other smartphone in the budget segment altogether. The Yureka was a thoroughly satisfying device and would make for a good buy, as long as Micromax can keep up good after sales service.

Prasid Banerjee



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Specifications

Display: 5.5-inch 720p IPS display; **Processor:** 1.5 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 64-bit octa-core SoC; **Battery:** 2500 mAh; **Operating System:** CyanogenMod 11, Android 4.4.4; **RAM:** 2GB; **Storage:** 16GB, expandable up to 32GB; **Camera:** 13MP rear, 5MP front.

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